

whatweretheythinking.com

www.bonebed.com/press/stormlands/index.htm

A preliminary note: as you read this, you're likely to be as confused as this Web site is! The creator of the site, Robert Bose, informs us that the site titled "The Stormlands" is a resource for anyone needing inspiration, campaign material, or an interesting read. Three widely varying objectives... but take a look at the side bar: Cosmology, The World, Campaigning, The Campaign. Now here's someone who will tutor you to campaign, while also having a Campaign of his own. We went ahead in our attempt to decipher.



We're brainstorming to figure out this one!!

"In the earliest times three mighty Powers arose from the very fabric of the cosmos. What greater force created them and to what ultimate purpose were questions never to be answered. All they knew was that they had come to be"... duh!

"The World" purports to introduce us to the geography, organisations and beasts that made up this "arcane" world. 'Races' attempts to classify the beings in Bose's imagined parallel universe. If you can suffer the descriptions, move ahead to a link named 'archetypes'. Again another classification, this time based on 'occupations'.

Under Equipments, Tables give you the range and specifications of weapons used in Bose's imagined "campaign" in painstaking detail. And finally, if you're not sapped already, venture into the Campaign, to find further characterisation, as if all the characters introduced so far weren't enough. We're absolutely clueless—the site says it will provide "inspiration," but for what? Actually, let's sum it all up: what on earth is this site about? Please, please take a look and try and tell us!

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by Beijing, and the subsequent jailing of a reporter because of the information the company released to the Chinese government. In an attempt to perhaps save face and also help alleviate some of the load, Yahoo! has issued a statement directed at the US government. If you cut out all the fancy words and jargon, the message quite simply says, "Helllllllllp!"

If you don't believe us, read the concerned lines for yourself:

"Private industry alone cannot effectively influence foreign government policies on issues like the free exchange of ideas, maximum access to information, and human rights reform, and we believe continued government-to-government dialogue is vital to achieve progress on these complex political issues.

"We will work with industry, government, academia and NGOs (non-governmental organisations) to explore policies to guide industry practices in

countries where content is treated more restrictively than in the United States, and to promote the principles of freedom of speech and expression."

Other Internet and technology companies being criticised by the masses include Google, Microsoft and Cisco, interestingly, all because of the deals they have struck with the Chinese government. Google provides watered-down search functionality in their Chinese version—actually censoring search results to omit links that the Chinese government deems immoral. Both Microsoft and Yahoo! pretty much do the same.

All we have to say is, give these companies a break; they need to make money, and China is the world's largest untapped Internet market for them. Besides, when the US government, with all its gazillions of dollars hasn't been able to tame China, what hope, in heaven's name, can corporates such as Yahoo!, Microsoft and Google have? ■

Blog WATCH

Xbox modding is a sin. Vista is vapourware. Google has woken up to the fact that people *do* delete mails. That's some of the stuff floating around in the blogosphere this month

Keith Stuart
<http://snipurl.com/blogmar1>

Chips are down for Xbox modder

A 22-year-old Cambridge graduate has just become the first person to be convicted for modifying a games console—a crime that, however hard I try, I cannot imagine cropping up on Law and Order Criminal Intent.

Importantly though, the felon didn't merely chip his console in order to play imported Japanese dating games. He was selling modified Xbox units complete with larger hard drives each filled with 80 pirated games....

Anyway, the man was sentenced at Caerphilly Magistrates' Court to 150 hours of community service—outside the court building, weeping Microsoft employees and their relatives screamed for justice and pelted police with warranty-invalidated consoles. That last bit may not have happened.

Did I tell you about the time I enraged Sega Japan by running a feature in DC: UK magazine instructing readers how to bypass the Dreamcast region lock-out? I'd probably be put away for that nowadays.

Kimobeer
<http://snipurl.com/blogmar2>

The Truth about Windows Vista? It's Vapourware

Surely a company will show the best features in a demonstration of this year's most important product launch at the world's most important consumer

electronics show, before partners, competitors and a gathering of media from all over the world?

The pictures from Gates' keynote show perfectly well what those features are: A way to scroll through your applications in 3D—and while alt tabbing your movies will be able to see your movies still playing and preview documents...

As a user, would these features make you stand in line to purchase a copy, some night in November when Microsoft chooses to launch Windows Vista?

Even Windows boss Jim Alchin seems to realise that his offering has become extremely weak. So in trying to justify the five years that his team spent on developing the product, he is now touting safety and security as Vista's big feature.

Tony Hill
<http://snipurl.com/blogmar3>

Gmail adds delete button

As I suspected, Gmail finally added an actual delete button to their interface. This entire time I have been painlessly been using a drop down menu to delete emails (Yes Gmail, I delete emails because I sign up for daily newsletters that I never had time to read.) Anyways, I'm not used to it yet, so I'm still clicking on the dropdown to delete and I keep 'starring' everything. Looks like Gmail just took out the old delete menu option and just replaced it with this button. I think they should have kept both. So people can slowly adjust, or maybe some people like using a drop down.